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# Git GUI Clients

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## Why use a GUI client?

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Git GUI clients let you use Git with buttons and menus instead of typing commands.

They are great for beginners, make it easier to see what's happening, and help you avoid common mistakes.

- See your branches and changes visually
- Stage, commit, and push with clicks
- Handle merge conflicts with helpful tools
- No need to remember command-line options

## Popular Git GUI Clients

- GitHub Desktop
- GitKraken
- Sourcetree
- Git GUI

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# GitHub Desktop

**GitHub Desktop** is a free, beginner-friendly app for Windows and Mac.

It works best with GitHub, but you can use it with other repositories too.

- **Pros:** Simple, clean interface. Great for GitHub users.
- **Cons:** Fewer advanced features. Not as flexible for non-GitHub platforms.

## Example workflow

```
1. Clone a repository from GitHub
2. Make changes to files
3. See changes in the app
4. Stage and commit with a message
5. Push to GitHub with one click
```

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It supports GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket, and more.

- **Pros:** Visual commit graph, built-in merge/conflict tools, works with many platforms.
- **Cons:** Some features require a paid license.

### Example workflow

```
1. Open a repository
2. Drag and drop to create branches
3. View history and merge visually
4. Resolve conflicts with built-in tools
5. Push changes to remote
```

## Sourcetree

**Sourcetree** is a free Git client from Atlassian, popular for Bitbucket but works with any Git repository.

- **Pros:** Free, full-featured, good for advanced users.
- **Cons:** Interface can be overwhelming for beginners.

### Example workflow

```
1. Add a repository
2. Stage and commit changes
3. Use the log/history view to see all commits
4. Push and pull with buttons
```

## Git GUI

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- **Pros:** Always available, lightweight, no extra install needed.
- **Cons:** Basic interface, fewer features than other clients.

### Example workflow

```
1. Open Git GUI from the Start menu
2. Select your repository folder
3. Stage files, write a commit message, and commit
4. Push to remote using the menu
```

## VS Code Git

**Visual Studio Code** has built-in Git support.

You can use the Source Control panel to stage, commit, push, pull, and resolve conflicts-all inside your code editor.

- **Pros:** Integrated with your editor, easy to use, works with extensions.
- **Cons:** Not as visual for history/branches as dedicated apps.

### Example workflow

```
1. Open a folder in VS Code
2. Make changes to files
3. Use the Source Control panel to stage and commit
4. Push and pull with buttons
```

## Other Clients

There are many other Git GUI clients, including:

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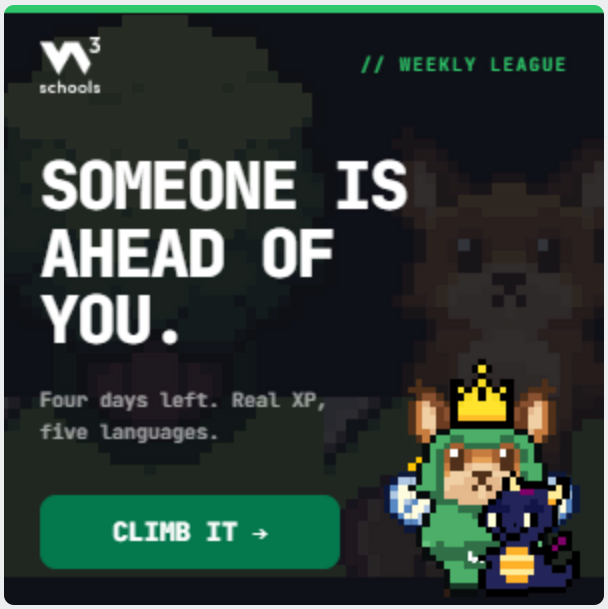
- Git-Cola

Most work in similar ways: you open a repo, see your changes, and use buttons for Git actions.

# Troubleshooting

- **Authentication issues:** Make sure you've set up SSH keys or personal access tokens if needed.
- **Changes not showing:** Refresh or re-scan your repo in the client.
- **Conflicts:** Use the merge/conflict tools built into your client, or fall back to the command line if stuck.

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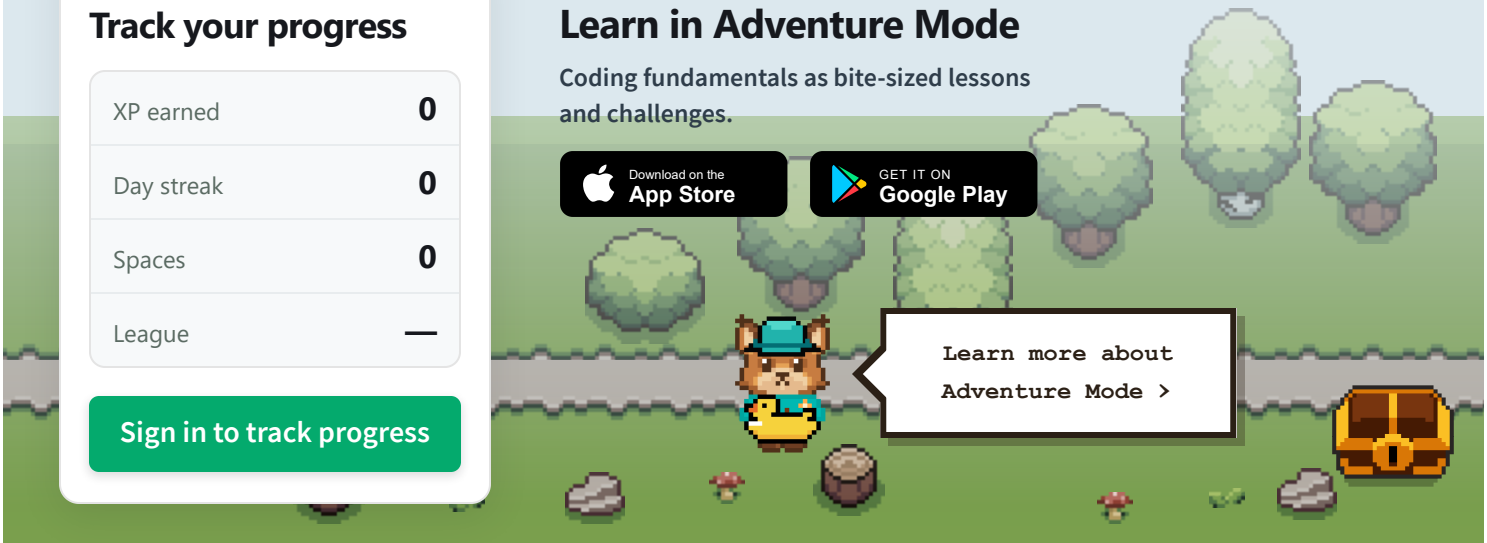



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